

# KodetoCareer — Founder Bible

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Version 1.0 | Confidential — Founding Team Only

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## 1. Why We Exist

Every year, millions of students in tier-2 and tier-3 Indian cities complete engineering degrees without the one thing they actually came for: a job.

It's not their fault. They are taught by instructors who haven't worked in industry. They learn from curricula written fifteen years ago. They graduate into a "placement cell" that is a single faculty member with a WhatsApp group, doing their best against impossible odds.

The system has failed them structurally. And the tragedy is compounded by the fact that India's tech industry is simultaneously facing a talent shortage — because the demand is for Python developers, ML engineers, and data scientists, not Java programmers who last updated their skills in 2014.

KodetoCareer exists to close this gap. Not by replacing colleges. Not by being another Udemy. By becoming the infrastructure layer that connects real-world industry training to real employment outcomes — at scale, across hundreds of colleges, for hundreds of thousands of students.

We are building the operating system for career-focused technical education in India.

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## 2. Our Mission and Vision

**Mission:** To make quality technical training and guaranteed placement infrastructure accessible to every student in India, regardless of which college they attend.

**Vision (10-year):** KodetoCareer is the trusted hiring pipeline for Indian tech employers and the definitive learning-to-employment platform for technical graduates — the platform that produced the engineers who built India's next generation of technology companies.

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## 3. Our Beliefs

These are not marketing statements. These are operating beliefs that shape every product, hiring, and business decision.

**We believe placement is the product, not the feature.**

Every company that sells "ed-tech" in India has eventually discovered that the only thing students — and their parents — actually care about is: did you get me a job? We build everything backwards from that question.

**We believe the training partner is the most underserved actor in education.**

Colleges want outcomes. Students want jobs. Recruiters want talent. But nobody has built for the company in the middle that does the actual hard work of upskilling and placing students. That's us.

**We believe data compounds.**

Every student we train generates data. Every placement we make generates trust. Every college we partner with generates reach. These aren't linear — they compound. The platform we're building is designed to generate compounding advantages that get stronger with every cohort.

**We believe software should feel like a privilege, not an obligation.**

Too many enterprise software products are tolerated, not loved. We want students to actually open the app every day — not because they're forced to, but because it shows them their progress, helps them prepare, and connects them to opportunity. That requires building software that respects their time and intelligence.

**We believe trust is the foundation.**

We make a placement promise. If we don't deliver, we lose. This means every claim we make must be measurable and true. Our data cannot be massaged. Our certificates must be earned, not distributed. Our placement numbers must be real.

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## 4. Business Model

### 4.1 Current Revenue (Training Fees)

KodetoCareer generates revenue by training students at colleges. The platform does not change this model — it makes it scalable and defensible.

**Current pricing example:**

- 4-month Python/ML/Data Science program
- Fee per student: ■15,000–■40,000 (varies by college arrangement)
- Revenue model: B2B to college OR B2C to students paid separately
- Platform enables: tracking, certificates, and placement proof that justify the fee

## 4.2 Near-Term Revenue Expansion (Year 1–2)

### College Partnership SaaS Fee:

Once the platform is live and proven with pilot colleges, charge partner colleges a per-semester SaaS fee for the College Dashboard and analytics.

- Pricing: ■25,000–■75,000 per college per semester
- Value proposition: replaces manual reporting, demonstrates ROI to NAAC/NIRF

### Premium Student Features:

Optional premium features for students who are job-seeking:

- Resume AI review
- Interview practice AI
- Recruiter profile visibility
- Price: ■499–■999/month

## 4.3 Medium-Term Revenue (Year 2–3)

### Recruiter Access:

Verified, skill-tagged student profiles become a hiring database.

- Charge recruiters for access: ■10,000–■50,000 per hiring drive
- Revenue share on successful hires

### Platform Licensing to Other Training Partners:

White-label the platform to other training companies who want the same infrastructure.

- SaaS license: ■2,00,000–■5,00,000/year per partner
- Revenue share on placements

### Government / CSR Contracts:

State skill development missions need digital infrastructure. Platform designed for this.

- Project-based contracts ■50L–■5Cr range

## 4.4 Unit Economics (Target State)

Metric | Target

CAC (College as customer) | ■50,000

LTV (College, 3 years) | ■5,00,000+

Gross Margin on SaaS | 70%+

Payback Period | < 12 months

Students per college per year | 200–500

Platform revenue per student | ■2,000–■5,000

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## 5. Go-to-Market Strategy

### Phase 1: Proof of Concept (Months 1–3)

**Goal:** 3 pilot colleges live on the platform with real students.

**Tactic:** Use existing relationships. The founder already has agreements with colleges. The MVP launch is not a sales motion — it is a proof-of-concept deployment with partners who trust us.

**Success metric:** 500 active students, 80% daily engagement, 90% certificate delivery rate, 3 documented placements.

### Phase 2: Reference Build (Months 4–9)

**Goal:** Turn 3 pilot colleges into 3 case studies that sell for us.

**Tactic:**

- Document placement outcomes with verifiable data
- Produce 3 one-page case studies: College name, students trained, placement rate, average package
- Use these as the primary sales asset for new college acquisition

**New college acquisition:**

- Direct outreach to placement officers and college directors in target geography
- Attend education expos (EduTech India, regional events)
- LinkedIn targeted outreach to TPO (Training & Placement Officers)

**Target:** 10 colleges, 2,000 students

### Phase 3: Scale (Year 2)

**Goal:** 50 colleges, 10,000 students, platform generates independent revenue.

**Tactic:**

- Hire 2 business development executives for college acquisition
- Partner with NASSCOM, CII, or AICTE for credibility and lead access
- Launch recruiter access model — turn placement data into a two-sided marketplace
- Begin SaaS licensing conversations with other training companies

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## 6. Competitive Moat

Our competitive advantage is not any single feature. It is the combination of:

**Data Moat:** We will know more about student skills, learning patterns, and placement outcomes than any other platform in our geography. This data has compounding value.

**Relationship Moat:** Colleges sign multi-year agreements. Students graduate and recommend us to their colleges. Recruiters who hire through us come back.

**Verification Moat:** KodetoCareer certificates have a public verification URL. Over time, recruiters will come to trust our certification because they have hired students who held them.

**Operations Moat:** Our platform makes the training partner's operations 10x more efficient. Switching away means losing all their historical data, analytics, and workflows. High switching cost = long retention.

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## 7. Culture & Values

### 7.1 How We Work

#### Ownership Culture:

Every team member owns their domain. A developer who builds the quiz system owns the quiz system — from design review to production bugs. We don't pass problems around. We take them.

#### Bias to Shipping:

A feature that is 80% perfect and deployed is worth more than a feature that is 100% perfect in development. We ship, we learn, we iterate. We do not plan in the dark for months.

#### Written Communication:

Decisions must be documented. The Founder Bible, PRDs, and architecture decisions exist so that the team can move fast without constant synchronous coordination. If a decision isn't written down, it doesn't exist.

#### Data Over Opinions:

We don't argue about what students want. We measure it. If engagement on a feature is below 20%, the feature is failing regardless of how strongly someone believes in it.

## 7.2 Hiring Principles

### **Hire for slope, not intercept.**

We prefer a candidate who has improved dramatically over 12 months over a candidate who peaked early. Learning speed matters more than current level.

### **Hire people who've shipped things.**

Real projects, side products, open source contributions — evidence of delivery. We do not hire people whose only experience is in academic settings.

### **Every hire must raise the team's average.**

The standard for our 10th hire is higher than the standard for our 5th hire. We always ask: is this person better than our current weakest link?

### **No brilliant jerks.**

Technical excellence does not excuse poor collaboration, communication, or treatment of teammates. Culture is non-negotiable.

## 7.3 Decision Making

For reversible decisions: individual or small group, move fast.

For irreversible decisions (architecture, pricing, key hires): write a one-pager, get input from all affected parties, then decide.

The founder makes the final call on product direction, hiring, and business model. Engineering leads make final calls on architecture. Design leads make final calls on UX within agreed frameworks.

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## 8. Founder Operating Principles

### **On the Platform:**

The platform is the product and the business simultaneously. Every hour spent on manual work that could be automated is an hour the business cannot scale. Automate aggressively from day one.

### **On Colleges:**

Colleges are our distribution channel, not our customer. The student is our customer. We must always serve both — but never forget that students are the reason we exist.

### **On Revenue:**

We will not discount our services to win a college that doesn't value them. A college that pays ■15,000 per student values the outcome. A college that demands ■5,000 per student values the price. We want the former.

**On Hiring:**

The first three engineers we hire will define the culture for the next fifty. Hire slowly. Hire right. Pay fairly.

**On Product:**

Build less. Build it well. Ship it fast. Listen to feedback. Improve. Repeat.

Never build a feature that can't be measured. Never measure a metric that can't be acted on.

**On Placements:**

Every unplaced student is a personal failure. Not a statistic. We know their name. We know their story. We will fight for their placement.

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## 9. Milestones & Success Definition

Milestone | Target Date | Definition

MVP Live | Month 3 | Platform live with 3 colleges, 500 students active

First Certificate Batch | Month 4 | 100+ certificates generated and delivered

First Placement Documented | Month 4 | 1 student placed with offer letter uploaded to platform

Platform Self-sustaining | Month 9 | Platform fee revenue covers AWS + 1 tech hire

10 Colleges | Month 12 | 10 active partner colleges, 2,000 students

Recruiter Marketplace | Month 18 | 5 recruiters paying for student access

Series A Ready | Month 24 | ■5Cr+ ARR, 30+ colleges, 10,000 students, placement rate > 60%

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## 10. What We Will Not Do

Being clear about what we will not do is as important as knowing what we will.

**We will not become a consumer ed-tech product.** We serve the training partner model. Going B2C at scale requires marketing budgets we do not have and will not chase.

**We will not compromise on placement data integrity.** Every placement number we publish must be real and verifiable. A platform built on inflated numbers will collapse.

**We will not build features for the sake of features.** The platform will never have a feature that doesn't solve a real problem for a real user. No bloatware.

**We will not raise VC money before we have product-market fit.** We will build profitably or on founder capital until we have clear evidence that more capital will multiply a working model, not discover one.

**We will not abandon tier-2 colleges for metro colleges.** Our mission is to serve the underserved. The moment we chase IIT alumni is the moment we've lost our reason to exist.

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*End of Founder Bible*

*This document should be updated quarterly as the company grows.*

*Classification: Confidential — Founding Team Only*